

THE SHED — Interactive Story Game

[THE SHED — Interactive Story Game (Super Duper Detailed)]

Working Title: *Bailee and the Secret of the Talking Backyard — The Shed*

Format: Web-first (mobile-friendly) interactive story adventure (no fail states)

Target Age: 6–10 (with optional “Read-to-Me” support)

Session Length: 15–30 minutes (Chapter 1)

Core Promise: A cozy, funny, magical backyard adventure where Bailee’s curiosity unlocks the world’s biggest secret: her pets can talk — and they’ve been waiting for her to notice.

1) FULL GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT (GDD)

1.1 Vision Statement

A narrative-first cozy adventure that feels like a playable picture book. Players guide Bailee through one backyard map, meeting talking animals through small, safe interactions. The emotional arc centers on **being seen** (Bailee’s sensitivity to being overlooked), **belonging**, and **curiosity as a superpower**.

1.2 Player Fantasy

- “I’m the kid who discovers the backyard’s secret.”
- “My pets are my team.”
- “I get to explore without being punished.”
- “My choices create funny reactions and warm connection.”

1.3 Pillars (Non-Negotiables)

1. **Cozy Safety:** No death, threats, or scary consequences. Mystery stays playful.
2. **Curiosity-Driven Progress:** Progress comes from noticing, interacting, asking.
3. **Character Comedy:** Dutchess chaos, Phoenix sighs, Chanel sass, Dragon mystery.
4. **Emotional Warmth:** Bailee's need to be noticed is validated, not shamed.
5. **Picture-Book Clarity:** Bright, readable composition; big buttons; simple UI.

1.4 Core Loop

1. **Explore** (tap/click to move; subtle shimmer on interactables)
2. **Interact** (objects + animals + environment)
3. **Receive** (dialogue, jokes, clues, "Wonder Sparks")
4. **Unlock** (new zone emphasis, animal trust, shed progress)
5. **Story Beat** (micro cutscene / illustrated panel)
6. Repeat until **Shed Reveal**

1.5 Tone & Writing Rules

- Bailee: bold, playful, snack-obsessed, soccer-obsessed, wants attention.
- Animals: distinct "TV show" voices; argue/tease; never mean.
- No lectures. "Heart line" moments are 1–2 sentences max.
- Spanish immersion flavor: occasional natural words ("¡Mira!", "¿Qué es eso?").

2) GAMEPLAY SYSTEMS

2.1 Controls

Move: tap/click ground → Bailee walks (bouncy skip).

Interact: tap/click interactable when in range.

Inspect Mode: long-press (mobile) / right-click (desktop) to zoom + Bailee thoughts.

Accessibility:

- Read-to-Me narration (toggle)

- Text size S/M/L
- Captions for SFX/music
- Reduced motion
- Highlight interactables (stronger shimmer)

2.2 Progression & Gating (Shed Unlock)

Goal: Open the shed.

How: Earn **3 Wonder Sparks** (represented as 3 icon slots on the shed lock UI). These are earned by completing three character-driven micro-quests:

1. **Dutchess** → Wonder Spark #1 (Pawprint)
2. **Phoenix** → Wonder Spark #2 (Bone)
3. **Chanel** → Wonder Spark #3 (Sparkle)

When all 3 are filled, the shed lock turns from **sleepy gray** to **warm gold** and the Knock interaction becomes available.

Important: No checklist. Progress is visual via the lock's 3 slots.

2.3 Interaction Types

- **Pick Up** (treat bag, brush, feather, shiny tag)
- **Use** (use treat on Dutchess; brush Phoenix; feather to engage Chanel)
- **Listen** (tap to “lean in” for audio cue)
- **Knock** (shed knock rhythm moment)
- **Pet (consent-based)** (Chanel only after permission; Phoenix always; Dutchess wiggles)

2.4 Inventory (Kid-Friendly)

Backpack icon opens a bottom tray with up to **6 large slots**.

- No crafting chains.
- Items are used 1–2 times max.
- Tooltips are funny.

Chapter items:

- Crunchy Treat
- Fruit Snacks
- Cheese Stick
- Phoenix Brush
- Fancy Feather
- Mystery Tag (Shiny)

2.5 Hint System

- Idle 12 seconds → Phoenix hint bubble: “Maybe check the garage path.”
- Tap shed too early → Bailee: “Not yet... it’s like it’s waiting for something.”
- If player ignores Chanel → Chanel meow + feather shimmer intensifies.

2.6 No Fail States

- Wrong choice = alternate funny line.
- No timer, no punishment.
- Progress always recoverable.

3) STORY STRUCTURE (CHAPTER 1: THE SHED)

3.1 Emotional Arc

Start: Bailee feels overlooked and bored.

Middle: The backyard behaves weird; Bailee senses a secret.

Climax: Shed opens; pets talk openly.

Resolution: Bailee realizes she’s never alone — her “big personality” belongs.

3.2 Beat Map

1. Intro porch scene (soccer + snacks + shed hint)
2. Dutchess chaos (first “almost talk” slip)
3. Exploration across zones
4. Phoenix calm task (brush + command)

5. Chanel trust moment (consent + sass)
6. Bearded dragon color shift (quiet magic)
7. Shed knock (unlock)
8. Shed reveal cutscene (full talking)
9. Outro promise (team)

4) WORLD / MAP DESIGN

4.1 Backyard Zones

A) Back Porch (Start)

- Props: porch steps, snack cooler, soccer ball, water bowl, wind chimes
- Interactables: cooler, ball, chimes

B) Grass Yard (Hub)

- Props: stepping stones, toys, butterfly, soft sparkle trail
- Interactables: pawprints, squeaker, sparkly grass clump

C) Tree Corner (Chanel)

- Props: low branch, birdhouse, leaf pile, feather on ground
- Interactables: feather, birdhouse peek

D) Garage Door / Side Path (Phoenix)

- Props: leash hook, brush on hook, hose, faint car-window sound cue
- Interactables: brush, leash (flavor)

E) The Shed (Goal)

- Props: lock with 3 slots, faint glow cracks, tiny sign “Do Not Disturb (...maybe)”
- Interactables: inspect lock, knock (late)

4.2 Visual Guidance

- Interactables shimmer.

- Sparkle “breadcrumbs” appear after key beats.
- Animals have strong idle loops.

5) CHARACTER VOICE BIBLES

5.1 Bailee

Voice: playful, dramatic, confident, snack + soccer obsessed.

Patterns:

- “Snack first.”
- “Messi would do it like this.”
- “¡Mira!”
- “That’s suspicious.”

5.2 Dutchess

Fast, panicky, dramatic, sweet chaos. Always thinks she’s in trouble.

5.3 Phoenix

Calm, wise, quietly funny. Sighs. Protective.

5.4 Chanel

Boujee, dramatic, judgmental, secretly playful. Consent queen.

5.5 Bearded Dragon

Quiet, thoughtful, minimal words. Color shifts show emotion.

6) QUESTS / MICRO-PUZZLES

6.1 Wonder Spark #1 — “The Treat Trail” (Dutchess)

Trigger: Dutchess bolts from porch → hub → near shed; crumbs/sparkles appear.

Player actions:

1. Talk to Dutchess (she half-speaks)
2. Acquire Crunchy Treat (from cooler if needed)
3. Follow sparkle crumbs
4. Use treat to calm Dutchess

Reward: Slot 1 fills (Pawprint).

6.2 Wonder Spark #2 — “The Calm Command” (Phoenix)

Trigger: Phoenix appears near garage path.

Player actions:

1. Pick up brush
2. Brush Phoenix 3 strokes (gentle rhythm)
3. Choose command: Sit or Stay

Reward: Slot 2 fills (Bone).

6.3 Wonder Spark #3 — “The Chanel Agreement” (Chanel)

Trigger: Chanel perched; refuses to help.

Player actions:

1. Find Fancy Feather
2. Approach with respectful dialogue
3. Do not pet until allowed
4. Receive Mystery Tag (Shiny)

Reward: Slot 3 fills (Sparkle).

6.4 Shed Door — “Knock-Knock Code”

Trigger: 3 slots filled.

Player action: Tap knock 3 times in any rhythm (perfect rhythm = extra sparkle).

Result: Lock clicks open; cutscene.

7) UI / UX SPEC

7.1 Full Screen List

1. Splash
2. Title
3. Save Slot/Profile
4. Settings/Accessibility
5. Chapter Select
6. Loading Tips
7. Gameplay HUD
8. Dialogue Mode
9. Inventory Tray
10. Pause Menu
11. Shed Door Focus View
12. Cutscene Panel View
13. End-of-Chapter Summary
14. Credits/Next Tease

7.2 UI Principles

- Big buttons, minimal text.
- Consistent icons.
- Soft highlight for next needed action.
- Parent-gated options behind hold-to-open.

8) UI WIREFRAMES (SCREEN BY SCREEN)

8.1 Splash Screen

Background: teal→sun yellow gradient + sparkles.

Center: “Bailee’s Backyard Stories” logo.

Bottom: loading bar with pawprint running.

8.2 Title Screen

Background art: Bailee + pets; shed far back with faint glow.

Top: THE SHED (big)

Center buttons: Play / Chapters / Settings

Bottom left: Read-to-Me toggle.

Bottom right: Parent icon (hold 2s) → credits/legal.

8.3 Save Slot / Profile

Top: Who’s playing?

Middle: 3 big cards (Slot 1 Continue; Slot 2 New; Slot 3 New)

Bottom: Optional name + Start.

8.4 Settings / Accessibility

Tabs: Audio | Text | Accessibility

Audio sliders: music/SFX/voice

Text: size S/M/L; captions on/off

Accessibility: read-to-me; highlight interactables; reduced motion

8.5 Chapter Select

Big card: Book 1: The Shed (Unlocked)

Locked silhouettes: The Garage / The Tree / The Snack Mystery

Bottom: Start Chapter

8.6 Loading Tips

Center rotating card tips:

- Tap shiny things
- Animals may “accidentally” tell secrets
- Chanel likes respect

Bottom: progress bar

8.7 Gameplay HUD

Top left: Bailee icon (+ name)

Top center: zone label

Top right: Pause

Bottom left: Backpack

Bottom center: Hint bubble (only when needed)

Bottom right: Shed progress (3 slots)

8.8 Dialogue Mode

Bottom third overlay.

Left: speaker portrait.

Center: text.

Right: choice buttons (1–3).

Top of overlay: auto-read icon.

Tap to continue.

8.9 Inventory Tray

Slides up from bottom with 6 large slots.

Tooltip on tap/hover.

Tap outside to close.

8.10 Pause Menu

Centered card: Resume / Settings / Restart / Exit

Background blurred.

8.11 Shed Door Focus View

Full screen zoom on shed door.

Center: lock + 3 slots.

Bottom: Knock button (only active when ready).

Right: Inspect (gives Bailee thoughts + hint).

8.12 Cutscene Panel View

Big illustration panel.

Bottom: narration (1–2 sentences).

Right: Next arrow.

8.13 End-of-Chapter Summary

Top: You opened The Shed!

Center: 3 earned stickers

Bottom: Replay / Back to Chapters / Next Tease

9) EXACT OPENING SCENE SCRIPT (SUPER DETAILED)

Scene: “Porch Boredom + The First Weird Moment”

Length: ~3–5 minutes

Scene Goals

- Introduce Bailee (curious, bold, snack + soccer)
- Establish cozy backyard vibe
- Hint shed is special
- Trigger Dutchess entrance + first “almost talking” slip

Scene Setup (Visual)

Late afternoon sun; warm gold tones.

Bailee sits on porch steps with soccer ball.

Snack cooler beside her.

Wind chimes moving.

Shed far back with the faintest sparkle at the lock.

Camera Direction

Wide establishing shot → slow push in → micro pans to shed during chime.

Opening Cutscene Panels

Panel 1 — Establish

Narration: “Bailee was the youngest. Which meant everyone was always doing *big people stuff*.”

Panel 2 — Bailee Close

Narration: “And when Bailee got bored... the world usually got interesting.”

Panel 3 — Snack + Soccer

Bailee: “Okay. Snack first. Then soccer. Then... whatever that is.”

SFX: *Cooler POP* (comedic twinkle)

Panel 4 — Shed Hint

Bailee (thought): “Why is the shed... shiny?”

Narration: “The shed had always been in the backyard. But today, it looked like it was trying to say... ‘Hi.’”

Transition to Gameplay

Prompt: Tap where you want Bailee to go!

Interactive Tutorial Beats

Beat A — Movement

- Highlight: cooler, ball, chimes.
- Random Bailee idles:
 - “Messi would be proud.”
 - “I wonder if there’s a secret snack compartment.”
 - “¡Mira! I’m fast.”

Beat B — Snack Cooler (Required)

Bailee: “Aha! My best friends: snacks.”

Choice:

1. Crunchy Treats (for Dutchess)
2. Fruit Snacks (for Bailee)
3. Cheese Stick (maybe everybody)

Outcomes:

- 1: “For Dutchess... because she acts like she’s never eaten.” (Gain Crunchy Treat)
- 2: “For me. Because I’m me.” (Gain Fruit Snacks)
- 3: “Cheese is happiness in a stick.” (Gain Cheese Stick)

Beat C — Wind Chimes

Bailee: “Okay... that was... kinda magical.”

(Camera pans 1s toward shed.)

Trigger Event — Dutchess Chaos Entrance

Trigger Condition

After snack choice OR 20 seconds wandering.

Animation

Dutchess bursts in from garage area; skid + spin.

SFX: *SCRITCH-SCRITCH* + *slide whistle*

Dialogue (Exact)

Dutchess: “BAILEE! BAILEE! BAILEE!”

Bailee: “Hi, Dutchess! Why are you yelling like the mailman is attacking you?”

Dutchess: “Because— because— I’m NOT in trouble! I’m just... doing... cardio!”

Bailee: “You don’t even know what cardio is.”

Dutchess: “YES I DO! It’s when your heart goes ‘BEEP BEEP’ and you run like THIS—”

Bailee: “Okay, okay! What’s going on?”

Dutchess (blurts then freezes): “THE SHED IS—”

SFX: *Record scratch*

Bailee: “...The shed is what?”

Dutchess: “Nothing! I said... ‘shed-derific.’ Like terrific. Shed-derific.”

Bailee: “That is the worst word I’ve ever heard.”

Dutchess: “THANK YOU! I MADE IT UP!”

Bailee: “Dutchess... did you just... talk?”

Dutchess (fast): “NO! I barked in... feelings! Feelings sound like words sometimes! Woof!”

Bailee: “That was not a woof.”

Dutchess: “IT WAS A SPIRITUAL WOOF!”

Player Choice (First Choice)

1. “Be honest: ‘I heard words.’”
2. “Play along: ‘Okayyy Spiritual Woof.’”
3. “Snack first: ‘Do you want a treat?’”

Choice 1 Outcome:

- Bailee: “Dutchess. I heard. Words.”
- Dutchess: “Words are common! Even chairs have words!”
- Bailee: “Chairs do not talk.”
- Dutchess: “You don’t KNOW that.”

Choice 2 Outcome:

- Bailee: “Mmm-hmm. Spiritual woof. Totally normal.”
- Dutchess: “YES! Normal! I am the normalest!”
- Bailee (aside): “Suspicious.”

Choice 3 Outcome:

- Bailee: “Okay, dramatic diva— do you want a treat?”
- Dutchess: “Treat?! I don’t even LIKE— I LOVE THEM!”

Common End Beat

Dutchess looks toward shed; faint sparkle trail appears.

Dutchess (small): “We’re not supposed to go near it. (But also... we totally should.)”

System Prompt: Follow Dutchess!

End Opening Scene.

10) DIALOGUE — WRITTEN EXACTLY FOR THE GAME (FULL CHAPTER)

10.1 Bailee Ambient Lines

1. “If I had a snack map, I would follow it.”
2. “Messi would definitely investigate the shed.”
3. “I feel like the backyard is... staring at me.”
4. “¡Hola, butterfly! Do you know secrets?”
5. “If Chanel is outside, she’s about to be rude.”
6. “Dutchess is either happy... or guilty. Same face.”

10.2 Object Interactions — Porch

Soccer ball: “Watch my footwork!” / “Goal! Into imaginary net!”

Cooler: “Snack time is the best time.”

Chimes: “That sounded like... a whisper.”

10.3 Follow Dutchess — Treat Trail

Dutchess (running):

- “This way! I mean— not this way— maybe this way!”
- “If anyone asks, we are doing... a WALK.”
- “I am innocent! But also fast!”

Sparkle clue:

- Bailee: “Ooo sparkles! I love sparkles.”
- Dutchess (whisper): “Pretend you don’t.”
- Bailee: “I can’t pretend that. It’s sparkles.”

Use treat (if have):

- Bailee: “Treat offering!”
- Dutchess: “I accept this very normal offering.”
- Bailee: “You’re my dog, not my employee.”
- Dutchess: “I can be both.”

No treat:

- Dutchess: “Do you have a treat?”
- Bailee: “I have... love?”
- Dutchess: “Love is not crunchy.”

Wonder Spark #1 awarded (Pawprint):

- Bailee: “Okay... something is definitely happening.”

10.4 Phoenix — Calm Command

Meet:

- Phoenix: “Hello, Bailee.”
- Bailee: “Phoenix! Did Dutchess escape again?”
- Phoenix (sigh): “Define ‘again.’”

Shed hint:

- Bailee: “Why is Dutchess acting like the shed is a celebrity?”
- Phoenix: “Because Dutchess cannot hold a secret. She sweats secrets.”
- Bailee: “Dogs can sweat?”
- Phoenix: “Metaphor.”

Brush:

- Bailee: “Aww, you like brushes.”
- Phoenix: “I like calm.”
- Bailee: “I can do calm. For five seconds.”

Command choice:

- Sit → Phoenix: “Ahead of you.”
- Stay → Phoenix: “That is my lifestyle.”

Wonder Spark #2 awarded (Bone):

- Phoenix: “Two down.”
- Bailee: “Two down what?”
- Phoenix: “Nothing.”

10.5 Chanel — The Agreement

First meet:

- Chanel: “Ew. Grass.”
- Bailee: “Hi Chanel! I missed you!”
- Chanel: “I was resting my beauty.”

Shed question:

- Bailee: “Do you know why the shed is shiny?”
- Chanel: “I know many things.”
- Bailee: “Will you tell me?”
- Chanel: “No.”

Feather:

- Bailee: “Ooo fancy feather!”
- Chanel: “It’s... acceptable.”

Approach choice:

1. Ask permission → “May I pet you, Your Majesty?” / “Finally. Manners.”
2. Compliment → “Cloud of perfection.” / “Correct.”
3. Joke → “I’m your favorite human.” / “You are... tolerated.”

If pet without permission:

- Chanel: “Absolutely not.”
- Bailee: “Okay okay. Consent queen.”

Mystery Tag:

- Chanel: “Fine. Take this.”
- Bailee: “What is it?”
- Chanel: “A secret. Obviously.”

Wonder Spark #3 awarded (Sparkle):

- Chanel: “The shed is about to be dramatic.”

10.6 Bearded Dragon Moment

- Bailee: “Hey little dude.”
- Dragon (soft): “Ready.”
- Bailee: “Me too.”

10.7 Shed Door Unlock

Inspect:

- Bailee: “Okay shed... I’m coming.”
- Phoenix: “Calm. Then chaos.”
- Dutchess: “I’m already chaos!”
- Chanel: “I’m elegance.”

Knock: “Knock knock knock!”

Lock click:

- Dutchess (tiny): “Uh-oh.”
- Bailee: “Uh-oh good or uh-oh bad?”
- Phoenix: “Uh-oh... truth.”

10.8 Shed Reveal Cutscene

- Narration: “It creaked like it had been holding its breath.”
- Bailee: “I’m not scared. I’m excited.”
- Dutchess: “Same. I’m sweating feelings.”
- Phoenix: “Welcome, Bailee.”
- Bailee: “...You said my name.”
- Chanel: “We’ve been waiting.”
- Bailee: “For me?”
- Dragon: “Yes.”
- Phoenix: “You notice things. That’s your gift.”
- Bailee: “So I’m not... too much?”
- Chanel: “You are exactly enough. Also bring snacks next time.”
- Bailee: “I ALWAYS bring snacks!”

Chapter End Narration: “And in that moment, Bailee didn’t feel small at all.”

11) PRODUCTION NOTES (FOR BUILDERS)

11.1 Asset List

Characters: Bailee (idle/walk/run/think/laugh), Dutchess (run/panic/sit), Phoenix (sit/blink/sigh), Chanel (perch/tail flick/pounce), Bearded Dragon (idle + color variants)

Backgrounds: porch, hub, tree corner, garage path, shed exterior, shed interior glow

UI: backpack, pause, shed progress, item icons

FX: sparkles, glow, shimmer highlights

Audio: wind chimes, footsteps, bark/whine, purr, soft music loops

11.2 Telemetry

Track: time to first wonder spark, shed taps early, idle hint triggers.

11.3 Kid-Safe Monetization (Optional)

One-time chapter unlocks + sticker book cosmetics. Parent gate only.

☒ Deliverables included: **Full GDD + Opening Scene Script + Screen-by-Screen Wireframes + Full Chapter Dialogue**

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Technical Notes (Generated by Codex)

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the-shed-game
the-shed-game/ ─ index.html (the game screen) ─ styles.css (colors, layout, cozy vibes) ─ game.js (logic, dialogue, interactions) ─ assets/ ─ images/ ─ audio/ ─ ui/ ─ data/ ─ dialogue.json (your amazing script lives here)
The Shed Game

A cozy, web-first interactive story game for kids ages 6-10.
Run the game
Open `index.html` in a browser. (For the best results on some browsers, serve the folder with a local web server.)
Project structure
```
index.html # Main game screen
styles.css # Cozy visuals, UI, animations
game.js # Game state + loop
movement.js # Tap/click movement logic
dialogue.js # Dialogue engine + choices
inventory.js # Inventory tray logic
progress.js # Wonder Sparks + shed lock
data/
dialogue.json # All dialogue + choices
scenes.json # Scene + trigger definitions
items.json # Inventory item data
assets/
images/
ui/
characters/
backgrounds/
audio/
sfx/
music/
```

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